

Kana

GTM Persona & Pain Point Mapping

CPG · Retail

Target roles · Pain points · Supporting data

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CPG

Consumer Packaged Goods · 5 Solutions · Target Roles & Pain Points

Category Intelligence Hub

TARGET ROLE / TITLE

Senior Category Manager · Director of Category Management · VP Category Development

1 Syndicated data arrives weeks late — by the time reports reach the team, the category is already moving

Most CPG category teams rely on weekly or bi-weekly syndicated data drops from retailer portals, processed manually into master spreadsheets. The insight lag means category managers are entering buyer meetings and planning cycles with a view of the category that's already stale — a critical disadvantage when consumers and competitors are shifting faster than ever.

SUPPORTING STAT

Agile, data-driven decision-making is especially critical to CPG companies as consumer preferences and buying patterns change faster than ever. Yet manual approaches to retail data analytics involve downloading, formatting, and consolidating reports — a process that is slow, error-prone, and usually outdated by the time it reaches an analyst.

NIQ / Crisp, CPG Data Analytics Guide 2025

2 External signals are never cross-referenced against internal POS data — contradictions go undetected

Category managers ingest analyst reports and trade publications but have no systematic way to verify those signals against their own scan data. A trend report may be predicting growth in a category that the brand's own shipment data quietly contradicts — and without a reconciliation layer, the team enters a buyer meeting committed to a narrative their own numbers disprove.

SUPPORTING STAT

45% of marketing data used for business decisions is incomplete, inaccurate, or outdated. No single CMO surveyed considered their data more than 75% reliable.

Adverity / ppc.land, September 2025

3 Category managers spend more time compiling data than generating insight — the strategic function is buried in operational work

Without an automated intelligence layer, category management teams manually pull data from retailer portals, reconcile sources, and build reports before any analysis can begin. The result: the most valuable strategic resource in the function — the category manager's judgment — is consumed by data assembly rather than insight and decision-making.

SUPPORTING STAT

*What previously took weeks of manual analysis now happens in hours with modern AI-enabled analytics tools.
64% faster time-to-insight is reported by teams adopting unified, AI-assisted data layers.*

Improvado / Coupler.io, Marketing Analytics Trends 2026

Omni-Channel Media Planner

TARGET ROLE / TITLE

Director of Omnichannel Marketing · VP Media & Performance Marketing · Senior Media Planner

1 For every \$1,000 spent programmatically, only \$439 actually reaches consumers

CPG brands allocate significant budget to programmatic channels — but without saturation modeling or efficiency benchmarking built into the planning process, waste compounds silently. Programmatic inefficiency has grown 34% in two years, driven by new sources of waste that have replaced old ones. Most CPG media teams lack the tooling to model diminishing returns per channel against their own historical campaign data.

SUPPORTING STAT

\$26.8 billion in global media value is lost each year to inefficiencies in programmatic advertising. Programmatic waste has climbed 34% in just two years, up from \$20 billion in 2023. Only \$439 of every \$1,000 spent programmatically reaches consumers.

ANA Q2 2025 Programmatic Transparency Benchmark

2 Campaign briefs lose fidelity as they move from strategy to live platform configuration

A CPG brief specifying 'Female HHs, 25–44, indexed on healthy snacking' gets interpreted differently by every platform manager. There is no shared canonical taxonomy mapping the brief to platform-specific targeting parameters across Meta, YouTube, TradeDesk, and DV360. By the time the campaign is live, it may be reaching a meaningfully different audience than intended — and no one catches it until ROAS has underperformed.

SUPPORTING STAT

42% of marketers cite audience mismatch as their most costly mistake. \$37 billion vanishes annually on poorly targeted ads.

Amra and Elma Marketing Statistics, 2025

3 Budget allocation across channels is driven by habit and last year's plan — not modeled to actual marginal ROAS

Most CPG brands reallocate media budgets based on previous year's channel mix rather than running saturation curve models against their own campaign data. This means chronically overspending on channels that have hit diminishing returns while underweighting channels where incremental spend would drive meaningful ROAS. The result: predictable plans, unpredictable outcomes.

SUPPORTING STAT

CPG social network ad spending is growing 15.1% year-over-year, with approximately 31.2% of CPG's digital ad budget allocated to social networks. Yet programmatic efficiency (TrueCPM Index) has declined, suggesting spend is rising faster than measured returns.

eMarketer CPG Digital Ad Spend 2024 / ANA Programmatic Benchmark 2025

Audience Manager

TARGET ROLE / TITLE

Campaign Operations Manager · Director of Marketing Operations · Performance Marketing Manager

1 Marketers wait days or weeks for data engineering to build audience segments — a strategic decision becomes an operational bottleneck

Building even a straightforward audience segment against a CPG brand's first-party or CRM data typically requires a data engineering ticket, SQL query authoring, data validation, and platform sync — a cycle that can stretch from 3 days to several weeks. By the time the segment is ready, the campaign brief may have already shifted or the launch window narrowed.

SUPPORTING STAT

Marketers often wait weeks or months for data teams to sync customer data to advertising and marketing tools. The total cost of a warehouse-first GTM data stack is \$1,000–\$10,000+/month when including engineering time, warehouse costs, and platform fees.

Castled / YC Launch Blog 2024; Landbase Marketing Ops Report 2025

2 Audience segments don't accurately reflect the brief's intent — the gap between what was requested and what ran is invisible

When data engineers translate a marketing brief into an audience query, nuance is lost. The brief's persona intent — behavioral, attitudinal, purchase-stage — collapses into available demographic or transactional filters. The resulting segment may be technically built but strategically misaligned, with no traceability back to the original brief.

SUPPORTING STAT

42% of marketers report that audience mismatch is their most costly mistake. \$37 billion is wasted annually on poorly targeted ads.

Amra and Elma Marketing Statistics, 2025

3 No documented link exists between the original campaign brief and the audiences that actually ran — post-campaign learning is impossible

Without brief-to-activation traceability, CPG marketing teams cannot determine whether a campaign underperformed because of creative, placement, timing, or audience inaccuracy. Every campaign becomes a new guess. The organizational knowledge that should compound after each flight — 'this segment worked; this one didn't' — never accumulates.

SUPPORTING STAT

Over 70% of marketers still lack year-over-year visibility into campaign performance, severely limiting strategic decision-making and budget defense.

funnel.io / 6sense, Marketing Measurement 2025

Marketing Intelligence

TARGET ROLE / TITLE

VP of Marketing Analytics · Director of Consumer Insights · CMO

1 CPG marketing teams cannot connect digital campaign performance to actual in-store sales lift — making ROI impossible to prove

Most CPG brands run digital campaigns (paid social, video, programmatic) but rely on proxies — impressions, reach, digital click-through — to claim impact. The actual connection to in-store volume lift, velocity changes, or share movement is almost never directly measured. Without it, marketing cannot defend budget to commercial leadership or retail buyers.

SUPPORTING STAT

More than 80% of retail transactions still take place offline. Digital analytics capture ad engagement and website visits, but the actual conversion — the sale — often happens in-store and remains unattributed to the campaign that drove it.

Cometly / Criterion Global, Offline Attribution Research 2025

2 Insight-to-action cycles span weeks — by the time analysts compile reports, the optimization window has already closed

CPG analytics teams assemble performance views by pulling data from ad platforms, retail portals, and internal BI tools — a manual cycle that takes days and often produces a report the day after a campaign flight ends. By the time leadership sees what's working, the budget is spent and the moment to optimize has passed.

SUPPORTING STAT

What previously took weeks of manual analysis now happens in hours with modern AI-enabled analytics platforms. Teams adopting unified analytics layers report 64% faster time-to-insight.

Improvado / Coupler.io, Marketing Analytics Trends 2026

3 Marketing is treated as a cost center because leadership cannot see a direct line from spend to revenue

CMOs face the perennial challenge: commercial leadership wants revenue attribution; marketing has impressions and qualified leads. The gap between what marketing can measure and what finance requires has made the function perpetually defensive. Without a direct connection from campaign activity to downstream sales or volume outcomes, budget cuts always fall disproportionately on marketing.

SUPPORTING STAT

Over 70% of marketers still lack year-over-year visibility into campaign performance. Only 44% of CMOs have formalized analytics frameworks despite 73% increasing analytics budgets.

funnel.io, Marketing Measurement Lessons 2025; Improvado Analytics Trends 2026

Synthetic Data Generation

TARGET ROLE / TITLE

VP Data & Analytics · Director of Audience Strategy · Head of Media Science

1 New product launches or new category entries lack sufficient first-party data to build accurate lookalike audiences

When a CPG brand enters a new segment or launches a new SKU, there is no historical consumer data to seed targeting models. The brand must either pay for expensive third-party audience data — which is often inaccurate for niche categories — or run broad, inefficient campaigns and iterate based on early performance. Both approaches waste budget during the launch window when efficiency matters most.

SUPPORTING STAT

Nearly 60% of marketing leaders believe that effectively collecting first-party data will become even more difficult as the industry transitions away from third-party cookies.

McKinsey 2024 CPG Survey, cited in NetSuite CPG Industry Trends 2025

2 Third-party audience data is unreliable and increasingly expensive — yet CPG campaigns still depend on it

Axiom, Experian, and Transunion are the de facto sources for audience enrichment and lookalike modeling in CPG campaigns. But the third-party data marketplace has faced sustained quality degradation from unreliable providers, and the cost of quality-certified segments has risen. CPG brands are overpaying for data they can't fully trust, with no reliable way to validate accuracy before spending against it.

SUPPORTING STAT

45% of marketing data used for business decisions is incomplete, inaccurate, or outdated. Poor data quality costs organizations an average of \$12.9 million annually.

Adverity / ppc.land, September 2025; Gartner Data Quality Estimate

3 The deprecation of third-party cookies is creating a growing gap between personalization ambitions and available data

CPG brands have invested heavily in building personalization capabilities but the data infrastructure underpinning those capabilities is eroding. Browser privacy changes, app tracking transparency, and GDPR-adjacent regulations across markets are reducing signal fidelity faster than first-party data collection can compensate. The brands that figure out how to maintain audience quality without third-party data will have a structural competitive advantage.

SUPPORTING STAT

The global data broker market was estimated at \$277.97 billion in 2024, but the industry's shift toward privacy-first frameworks is accelerating the deprecation of reliable third-party signal, with unreliable providers having already diluted overall marketplace quality and trust.

Grand View Research, Data Broker Market Report 2024; Experian Marketing Forward 2025

Retail

Retail & E-Commerce · 5 Solutions · Target Roles & Pain Points

Marketing Intelligence

TARGET ROLE / TITLE

VP of Digital Marketing · Director of Marketing Analytics · CMO

1 Digital campaigns drive store visits and offline conversions that never get credited to marketing

Retail marketing teams invest heavily in paid social, email, and digital video — but the sales that result from those campaigns often happen in-store, where the attribution chain breaks. Email open rates, ROAS from Meta, and click-through on digital display look strong, but no one can prove whether those actions drove an incremental trip to the physical store. Marketing's actual contribution to revenue remains hidden.

SUPPORTING STAT

More than 80% of retail transactions still take place offline. Campaigns may appear to underperform in digital analytics while actually driving substantial offline revenue — a gap that routinely causes brands to cut budgets on ads that are filling store traffic.

Cometly / Criterion Global, Offline Attribution Research 2025

2 Insight-to-action cycles span days or weeks — campaigns end before the team can optimize

Retail marketing analytics teams assemble performance views from multiple disconnected sources: ad platform dashboards, e-commerce analytics, email tools, and loyalty platform reports. Consolidating this into a single coherent view takes days and requires significant analyst time. By the time the analysis is ready, the promotional window has closed and the budget is already spent.

SUPPORTING STAT

Teams adopting unified AI-assisted analytics layers report 64% faster time-to-insight. What previously took weeks of manual analysis now happens in hours, enabling mid-flight optimization rather than post-campaign autopsy.

Improvado / Coupler.io, Marketing Analytics Trends 2026

3 Marketing cannot demonstrate revenue contribution to commercial leadership — budget defense is a recurring struggle

Retail CMOs face persistent pressure from CFOs and boards who see marketing as a cost to manage rather than a revenue driver to invest in. Without a direct, auditable path from campaign spend to SKU velocity, basket size, or customer LTV, marketing is reduced to reporting impressions and click-through rates — metrics that commercial leadership views as proxies, not proof.

SUPPORTING STAT

Over 70% of marketers still lack year-over-year visibility into campaign performance. Only 44% of CMOs have formalized analytics frameworks despite 73% increasing analytics budgets.

funnel.io, Marketing Measurement Lessons 2025; Improvado Analytics Trends 2026

Customer Engagement

TARGET ROLE / TITLE

Director of CRM & Loyalty · VP Retention & Lifecycle Marketing · Head of Customer Success

1 Retail churn rates of 22–24% are industry-wide — and replacing each lost customer costs 5–6x more than retaining them

Retail loyalty is highly transactional and price-sensitive. Customers who appear active — opening emails, visiting the site — can quietly shift their primary spend to a competitor before any behavioral signal triggers an intervention. By the time churn appears in retention reports, the customer is already gone. The cost of reacquisition consistently exceeds the cost of the retention investment that would have prevented the loss.

SUPPORTING STAT

General retail has a 24% churn rate; online retail sits at 22%. Attracting a new customer costs up to 6x more than retaining a loyal one. Your chances of selling to a new customer are just 5–20%, versus 60–70% for existing customers.

Open Loyalty / Capital One Shopping, Loyalty Statistics 2025

2 Retention campaigns burn margin on customers who were already coming back — while missing the ones who actually needed intervention

Blanket discounts and loyalty promotions are indiscriminate by design: they reach the full loyalty base, not the segment at meaningful risk of lapsing. The result is a significant and unmeasured transfer of margin to customers who would have purchased at full price, while the customers actually at the edge of churning receive the same discount and churn anyway.

SUPPORTING STAT

31% of American consumers buy more than they intended when they have a coupon — meaning discount-driven retention programs risk training otherwise-loyal customers to wait for incentives rather than purchasing at full price.

Capital One Shopping, Discount Statistics 2025

3 Churn prediction signals exist weeks before a customer lapses — but without behavioral scoring, teams only see it in reports after the fact

Before a loyal customer stops returning, behavioral signals are visible: declining purchase frequency, smaller basket sizes, app disengagement, category shifts. These signals reliably precede churn by 4–8 weeks. Without a predictive scoring layer that reads those signals in real time and surfaces at-risk customers, retention teams are perpetually reacting to churn they could have prevented.

SUPPORTING STAT

Lowering customer churn is the #2 loyalty marketing goal for 2024, cited by 49% of loyalty program managers. Top loyalty program managers cite improving overall CLV (56%), lowering churn (49%), and increasing purchase frequency (45%) as their primary goals — all of which require early-warning behavioral signals.

Open Loyalty, Key Loyalty Program Statistics 2026

Synthetic Data Generation

TARGET ROLE / TITLE

Director of Audience & Data Strategy · Head of Retail Media · VP Data Science

1 New store openings and geographic expansions lack the first-party data history needed to model audiences accurately

When a retail brand opens stores in new markets or expands its e-commerce to new regions, it enters those markets with little or no first-party consumer data for that geography. Third-party data from providers like Acxiom or Experian fills the gap but at high cost and with accuracy challenges for specific micro-markets. The result: launch campaigns are broad, inefficient, and expensive to iterate.

SUPPORTING STAT

Nearly 60% of marketing leaders believe that effectively collecting first-party data will become even more difficult as the industry transitions away from third-party cookies. Poor data quality costs organizations an average of \$12.9 million annually.

McKinsey 2024 CPG Survey; Gartner Data Quality Estimate

2 Fragmented identity data across POS, e-commerce, and loyalty platforms produces poor match rates on paid media — wasting activation budget

Retail brands have rich purchase and loyalty data, but it lives in siloed systems that use different customer identifiers. When this fragmented data is uploaded to Meta, Google, or The Trade Desk for lookalike modeling, match rates are low because identifiers don't resolve cleanly across platforms. The audience that gets built is smaller and less precise than the available data should allow.

SUPPORTING STAT

45% of marketing data used for business decisions is incomplete, inaccurate, or outdated. \$37 billion is wasted annually on poorly targeted advertising — driven significantly by identity and audience data quality failures.

Adverity 2025; Amra and Elma Marketing Statistics 2025

3 Third-party data providers are expensive and inaccurate — but retailers still depend on them to fill audience gaps for advertiser briefs

Retailers and Retail Media Networks need to respond to advertiser briefs that require audiences their first-party data doesn't fully support — in terms of demographics, psychographics, or geographic reach. This dependence on external providers is costly, and the quality of the data degrades campaign performance in ways that take time to detect — by then the budget is spent.

SUPPORTING STAT

The global data broker market reached \$277.97 billion in 2024. Yet unreliable providers have diluted the overall quality and trust of the third-party data marketplace, with marketers unable to validate accuracy before spending against it.

Grand View Research, Data Broker Market Report 2024

Audience Manager

TARGET ROLE / TITLE

Campaign Manager · Marketing Operations Lead · Head of Digital Activation

1 Audience segments are still built by data engineering teams — marketers wait days or weeks to activate against intended customer profiles

Retail campaign teams brief audiences in strategic language — 'lapsed loyalists in the Northeast who last purchased in Q4' — and then wait for a data engineering ticket to be picked up, queried in SQL, validated, and synced to the activation platform. In fast-moving retail environments where promotional windows open and close in days, this cycle is too slow. Campaigns launch late, or with whatever segment was already available rather than the one that was needed.

SUPPORTING STAT

Marketers often wait weeks or months for data teams to sync customer data to advertising and marketing tools. Complex SQL queries are required to create even the most straightforward customer segments.

Castled / YC Launch Blog 2024; Landbase Marketing Ops Report 2025

2 42% of marketers cite audience mismatch as their most costly mistake — and the gap is growing as campaigns run across more channels

As retail campaigns scale across Meta, Google, email, CRM, and loyalty platforms simultaneously, the risk of each channel running against a slightly different interpretation of the same audience brief compounds. There's no canonical audience definition enforced across platforms — each channel manager builds to their own understanding of the brief, creating measurement fragmentation and diluted targeting.

SUPPORTING STAT

42% of marketers report audience mismatch as their most costly mistake. \$37 billion is wasted annually on poorly targeted ads.

Amra and Elma Marketing Statistics, 2025

3 No documented link between campaign brief and activated audiences makes post-campaign learning and compliance impossible

When retail campaigns underperform, teams have no way to trace whether the audience that ran matched the original brief's intent. Every underperforming campaign prompts the same inconclusive post-mortem: was it the creative, the placement, the timing, or the audience? Without brief-to-activation traceability, the question cannot be answered — and the same mistakes recur in the next planning cycle.

SUPPORTING STAT

Over 70% of marketers still lack year-over-year visibility into campaign performance, severely limiting their ability to build on what worked and avoid repeating what didn't.

funnel.io, Marketing Measurement Lessons 2025

Omni-Channel Media Planner

TARGET ROLE / TITLE

VP Omnichannel Strategy · Director of Performance Marketing · Media Planning Lead

1 73% of retail shoppers engage across multiple channels — but only 35% of brands achieve true omnichannel personalization

Retail customers begin their journey on one channel and convert on another — and often on another after that. Most retailers know their customers are omnichannel shoppers, but they plan and measure each channel independently. The result is a fragmented customer experience that fails to reinforce itself across touchpoints, and a media plan that cannot be optimized against the actual multi-touch journey.

SUPPORTING STAT

73% of retail shoppers engage across multiple channels during their buying journey. Single-channel retailers achieve just 5.4% engagement rates; those operating three or more channels see engagement jump to 19.0%. Yet only 35% of companies achieve omnichannel personalization.

MoEngage Omnichannel Marketing Statistics 2025; Contentful Personalization Statistics 2025

2 \$26.8B in programmatic spend is wasted annually — without channel saturation modeling, retail brands can't identify where budget has hit diminishing returns

Retail media budgets are growing — retail media network spend, social, programmatic, CTV — but the optimization infrastructure hasn't kept pace. Budget allocation decisions still rely on last year's channel mix and marketing intuition rather than channel-specific saturation curves built on the brand's own campaign data. The result: predictable plans, unpredictable outcomes, and missed ROI that's hard to diagnose after the fact.

SUPPORTING STAT

\$26.8 billion in global media value is lost each year to programmatic inefficiencies. Waste has climbed 34% in two years. For every \$1,000 spent programmatically, only \$439 actually reaches consumers.

ANA Q2 2025 Programmatic Transparency Benchmark

3 Personalization drives a 40% revenue uplift — the gap between personalized and non-personalized retail is becoming a structural competitive disadvantage

The personalization gap between leading and lagging retailers is widening every year. Brands that leverage first-party data across channels to deliver personalized messaging, timing, and offers are compounding advantages in retention, conversion rate, and basket size. Brands that can't execute omnichannel personalization are not just leaving revenue on the table — they are conceding share to brands that can.

SUPPORTING STAT

Brands leveraging first-party data for omnichannel personalization see a 40% boost in revenue. 80% of businesses report higher consumer spending when experiences are tailored. 76% of consumers express frustration when personalization is absent.

Contentful, 40 Personalization Statistics 2025; MoEngage Omnichannel Report 2025